

DIRECTORATE OF ELECTRICITY DUTY

The Directorate of Electricity was in existence from 1910 under the administrative control of the Commerce and Industries Department, Government of West Bengal and subsequently under the Power Department with the Chief Electrical Inspector as the Head of the Directorate. With the enactment of the Bengal Electricity Duty Act, 1935 a separate wing came into existence as Bengal Electricity Duty Wing under the same Directorate under the administrative control of Finance (Taxation) Department, Govt. of West Bengal.

The Directorate of Electricity Duty came into existence from the 1st January 1997 under the administrative control of the Finance (Revenue) Department, Govt. of West Bengal. The Commissioner, Agricultural Income Tax became the ex-officio Director of Electricity Duty.

The Act

The Bengal Electricity Duty Act, 1935 envisages levy and collection of Electricity Duty on the net charges for electrical energy consumed or the units of energy consumed, as the case may be, at rates specified in the first schedule of the ACT.

Rates of Electricity Duty

- For energy other than energy supplied by a Licensee or the State Government
- For energy Supplied by the Licensee, like CESC, WBSEB etc.

Sl.No	Nature of Supply	Units Consumed	Rate of Elec.Duty
1.	Low and Medium voltage for Domestic purpose	Up to 300 units 301 Units and above	Nil 10.0%
2.	High Voltage for Domestic purpose	For each unit	15.0%
3.	Low Voltage energy for Commercial purpose	Up to 150 units 151-500 units 501-1000 units above 1000 units	Nil 10.0% 12.5% 15.0%
4.	High Voltage energy for Commercial purpose	For each unit	17.5
5.	Low Voltage energy for Industrial purpose	Up to 500 units 501-2000 units 2001-3500 units above 3500 units	Nil 2.5% 7.5% 12.5%
6.	High Voltage energy for Industrial Purpose	For each unit	15.0%

Exemption from Payment of Electricity Duty

- Any person generating electrical energy from plant using Diesel or Waste-Gas as fuels including cold storage and cinema houses for own consumption and registered under this Act.
- Government Establishments and Local Bodies.
- Railways
- General utility services like Hospitals, Burial and Burning ground
- Premises declared by the State Government to be used for public charity
- Energy consumed for irrigation for agricultural purpose
- Vessels, either sea-going or inland
- Industrial unit set up in "Special Economic Zone" notified by Government of India
- 100% Export oriented unit (EOU) set in any area other than Special Economic Zone

Assessing Authority

Sl No	Assessing Authority	Class of Assesee	Jurisdiction
1.	Agricultural Income Tax Officer as Electricity Duty Officer	Licensee	CESC and WBSEB
2.	Inspecting Officer	Non-licensee	North and South 24-Parganas and the area of supply of the CESC
3.	Electricity Duty Officer or Deputy Magistrate authorised by District Collector	Licensees other than CESC and WBSEB	Entire District
4.	Inspecting Officer and / or Deputy Magistrate Duly authorised by District Collector	Non-licensee	Entire District

Organisation

The Directorate of Electricity Duty is situated at 1, Harish Mukherjee Road, Kolkata-700020. Besides, there are two; Zonal Offices in the State as follows:

1. Asansole Zonal Office is located at P.O. Radhanagar Road, Burnpur, District-Burdwan, Tel. No. 0341-2283669. The Districts of Burdwan, Birbhum, Bankura and Purulia, come under the jurisdiction.
2. Jalpaiguri Zonal Office is located at State Bank More, P.O. & Dist. Jalpaiguri, Darjeeling, Uttar and Dakshin Dinajpur and Malda come under its jurisdiction

The Commissioner, Agricultural Income Tax, is ex-officio Director of Electricity Duty, performs statutory functions as the Prescribed Authority not only from 1. Harish Mukherjee Road but also from New Secretariat Buildings (12th floor), 1, Kiran Sankar Roy Road, Kolkata-700 001.

For further more information, the members of the Public may contact the following persons:

1. Director of Electricity Duty at Tel. No. 2248-4778, Fax No. 2248-4778
2. Senior Inspecting Officer at Tel. No. 2223-3511

Technical Info

✉ Visitor Count : 55411925

📞 Launched On : 13-01-2005

📞 Last Updated :

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